BENTONVILLE, ARKANSAS

KARST

Brand Direction

407–409 SE F St — SE Market District

February 2026

Confidential

Light Brand — Bentonville Wellness Center

> *Working brand direction for pitch deck and early conversations. Not a full brand system — enough for consistency and resonance.*

Name Candidates

Recommended Shortlist

RANK	NAME	RATIONALE	DOMAIN PATH	CONFLICT RISK
1	**KARST**	The geological term for Ozark limestone cave/spring landscape. Precise, premium, brief. Sounds Nordic. Completely original in wellness.	karst.health, karst.co	Low — no wellness trademarks found
2	**VEIL**	Ozark waterfall mist curtains through bluff faces. Evokes threshold, transition, the boundary between states. One syllable, luxury-coded.	veil.health	Low — bridal association exists but no wellness conflict
3	**SINTER**	Mineral deposit left by spring water on cave surfaces. Short, Scandinavian-sounding, completely unoccupied in wellness. Perfect for a contrast therapy concept.	sinter.health, sinter.co	Very low
4	**LOESS**	Wind-deposited sediment in Ozark valleys (pronounced “luss”). Ancient, layered, poetic. Sounds European. Zero commercial use in wellness.	loess.health, loess.co	Very low — pronunciation barrier is the main risk

RANK	NAME	RATIONALE	DOMAIN PATH	CONFLICT RISK
5	**HOLLOW**	A wooded valley between ridges — the most distinctly Ozark word. Dual meaning: empty/quiet (meditative) + literal geography. One syllable, memorable.	hollow.health	Moderate — common word, broader mark landscape

Eliminated Options

- **Ridgeline** — Honda Ridgeline truck trademark creates brand confusion
- **Canopy** — Canopy by Hilton creates unnecessary legal friction
- **Escarpment** — Too long for primary mark, though strong as descriptor

Previous Partner Suggestions (Not Recommended as Primary)

- Allostasis — too clinical/academic
- WellSpring — generic, widely used
- Onsen of the Ozarks — too literal, limits the concept

Naming Direction Notes

All five candidates draw from **Ozark geology** — the literal landscape that defines the building's cave-to-sky narrative. They sound Nordic or European without being literal. They work as standalone words (no "wellness center" suffix needed). Each is premium, slightly unexpected, and rewards discovery.

Tagline Candidates

OPTION	COPY	WHY IT WORKS
Primary	“Ancient ground. Present moment.”	Grounds the temporal claim (ancient healing) in experiential promise (presence). “Ground” is literal (underground) and philosophical.
Narrative	“From limestone to sky.”	Tells the architectural story in four words. Specific to Ozark geology. Works as campaign/secondary line.
Conceptual	“Where depth meets daylight.”	Captures the vertical journey (deep underground → emerge to light). Reads both physically and psychologically.

Visual Direction: Ozark-Nordic

Mood

Think: a handcrafted Scandinavian sauna house transplanted into an Ozark hollow. Ancient stone meets warm timber meets atmospheric light. Not spa-sleek, not rustic-rough. Refined and grounded.

Reference Aesthetic

- E. Fay Jones (Thorncrown Chapel) — soaring timber, glass, stone, forest
- Löyly Helsinki — slatted wood, sauna culture, waterfront minimalism
- Blue Lagoon Retreat — volcanic stone, atmospheric pools, moody lighting
- The Record (Bentonville) — local boutique hospitality, warm materials
- Kengo Kuma — layered timber, filtered light, landscape integration

Photography Direction

- Natural light, golden hour and overcast preferred
- Steam/mist/atmosphere in thermal spaces
- Warm skin tones, diverse bodies in recovery
- Ozark landscape context — hills, trails, limestone outcrops
- Architecture as hero — the building is the brand

Color Palette

A minimal palette rooted in Ozark geology and Nordic warmth:

ROLE	COLOR	HEX	REFERENCE
Primary dark	Ozark Charcoal	`#2C2C2C`	Wet limestone in a cave
Primary warm	Cedar	`#B87333`	Cedar paneling in sauna, warm timber glow
Neutral light	Limestone	`#E8E0D4`	Local Ozark limestone, sunlit
Neutral mid	Riverstone	`#9B958C`	River-tumbled stone, changing rooms
Accent	Spring Water	`#6B8F8E`	Ozark spring pools, mineral water
Background	Warm White	`#FAF7F2`	Natural light through greenhouse glass

Usage Rules

- **Background:** Warm White with Limestone accents
- **Text:** Ozark Charcoal on light backgrounds
- **Accent:** Spring Water used sparingly — one moment of color, not everywhere
- **Cedar:** Warm highlights, CTAs, emphasis
- **Riverstone:** Secondary text, captions, muted elements

Typography

Primary: Inter

- Clean, modern, highly legible
- Weights: Light (300), Regular (400), SemiBold (600), Bold (700)
- Use: Body text, navigation, captions, UI elements

Display: Instrument Serif (or similar editorial serif)

- Elegant, editorial authority
- Weights: Regular (400), Italic
- Use: Headlines, section titles, pull quotes, hero text

Accent: JetBrains Mono

- Technical precision, monospace
- Weights: Regular (400)
- Use: Data callouts, stats, pricing, labels — very sparingly

Type Scale

ELEMENT	FONT	SIZE	WEIGHT	TRACKING
Display headline	Instrument Serif	48-72px	Regular	-0.02em
Section title	Instrument Serif	28-36px	Regular	-0.01em
Subhead	Inter	20-24px	SemiBold	0
Body	Inter	16-18px	Regular	0
Caption	Inter	13-14px	Regular	0.01em
Data callout	JetBrains Mono	14-16px	Regular	0
Small label	Inter	11-12px	SemiBold	0.05em, uppercase

Cipher Relationship

Cipher is the silent methodology partner.

- The wellness center's programming draws on Cipher's experiment-based, tool-agnostic, human-first health optimization framework
- The brands are **completely independent** — no co-branding, no "powered by Cipher" badging
- Jordan's personal brand (Cipher) and the wellness center brand exist in separate brand architectures
- This protects both: Cipher can grow nationally as a digital brand; the wellness center develops its own local identity
- In investor/developer conversations, Jordan's Cipher background is part of his personal credibility, not the center's brand story

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Pitch Deck Design Direction

For the pitch deck specifically:

Layout

- Clean, generous whitespace
- Full-bleed photography where available (use AI-generated concept renders)
- Dark slides for atmospheric/experiential sections (Cave, thermal)
- Light slides for data, business model, team
- Typography-led slides for key thesis statements

Slide Template

- **Title slides:** Instrument Serif display headline, Warm White or Ozark Charcoal background
- **Content slides:** Inter body, clean tables and charts, minimal decoration
- **Image slides:** Full-bleed with text overlay (dark scrim where needed)
- **Data slides:** JetBrains Mono for numbers, Inter for labels

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Note: All name candidates require formal trademark clearance (USPTO IC 044) and domain verification at registrar before any commitments. This is a working brand direction, not a finalized identity.

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